



PROTECTING NETWORKS.
EMPOWERING PEOPLE.
DELIVERING EXCELLENCE.



THE FIRESIDE WAY

NOC TEAM EDITION

A PRACTICAL GUIDE TO EXCEPTIONAL NOC OPERATIONS

PEOPLE • PROCESS • PERFORMANCE

WE SEE IT.
WE OWN IT.
WE SOLVE IT.
TOGETHER.



PROTECT
OUR CUSTOMERS



COMMUNICATE
WITH CLARITY



COLLABORATE
AS ONE TEAM



IMPROVE
CONTINUOUSLY



DELIVER
EXCEPTIONAL
OUTCOMES

STRONGER TOGETHER. FASTER TOGETHER. BETTER EVERY DAY.

THE FIRESIDE WAY

NOC TEAM EDITION

EPISODE 1: WELCOME TO THE NOC

The Network Operations Center (NOC) is the heartbeat of Fireside Group.

We monitor. We detect.
We respond. We keep
our customers connected
24/7, every day.

Welcome to the NOC,
Daniel! This is where
we keep the network
running and our
customers connected.



WE MONITOR.
WE RESPOND.
WE KEEP YOU
CONNECTED.

Every alert.
Every packet.
Every connection.
It all comes
through here.

NOC
WE NEVER SLEEP
SO YOU CAN.

MEET YOUR TEAM



I'm Grace.
I'm a Senior
NOC Engineer.
I'll help you
learn the ropes.

GRACE
SENIOR NOC ENGINEER



I'm Brian.
I lead the
NOC team.
We win
together.

BRIAN
NOC TEAM LEAD



I'm Amina.
I handle security
alerts and
escalations.
When it's critical,
I've got your
back.

AMINA
SECURITY SPECIALIST



I'm Kevin.
I work with
field teams
and help close
the loop on
incidents.

KEVIN
FIELD SUPPORT ENGINEER

WHAT WE DO

-  **MONITOR**
We continuously monitor
networks, systems, and services.
-  **DETECT**
We detect issues before they
impact our customers.
-  **RESPOND**
We troubleshoot and resolve
incidents fast.
-  **SUPPORT**
We communicate, escalate,
and support our customers.
-  **IMPROVE**
We learn from every event to
make the network stronger.



This is a lot to
learn, but I'm
ready to give
it my all!

You're not
alone, Daniel.
We've got the
tools, the process,
and the team to
help you succeed.

OUR MISSION

PROTECT THE NETWORK.
ENABLE THE BUSINESS.
DELIVER EXCELLENCE.



RELIABLE
NETWORKS



FAST
RESPONSE



STRONG
SECURITY



TEAM
WORK

WELCOME ABOARD!



Thanks team!
Let's keep our
customers
connected
and our
network strong!

THE FIRESIDE WAY

NOC TEAM EDITION



EPISODE 2: UNDERSTANDING NETWORK MONITORING

Network monitoring gives us real-time visibility into our systems, devices, and services. It helps us detect issues early, protect performance, and keep our customers connected.

Visibility prevents downtime.

Monitoring is our eyes on the network—24/7, every day.



WHAT WE MONITOR

- Network Devices (Routers, Switches, Firewalls)
- Servers & Systems
- Applications & Services
- Links & Circuits
- Security Events
- Performance Metrics

OUR MONITORING DASHBOARDS

NETWORK MAPS

See the big picture. Track devices, links, and status across the network.

PERFORMANCE GRAPHS

Monitor bandwidth, CPU, memory, latency, and more in real time.

ALERT CONSOLE

TIME	SEVERITY	MESSAGE
09:14:21	CRITICAL	Core Router R1 - Down
09:14:35	MAJOR	High Packet Loss - MPLS Link
09:15:02	WARNING	High CPU - Server APP01
09:15:45	INFO	Backup Link - Up

Real-time alerts help us spot issues the moment they happen.

SERVICE STATUS

Service	Status
Internet Gateway	UP
MPLS Network	UP
Voice Services	UP
Cloud Services	UP
Customer Portal	UP

Check the health of critical services at a glance.

DEVICE HEALTH

Status	Count
Up	157
Warning	12
Down	3
Unknown	4

Instant overview of device status across the infrastructure.

TYPES OF MONITORING

- AVAILABILITY**
Is the device or service up?
- PERFORMANCE**
Is the network performing well?
- CONFIGURATION**
Has something changed?
- SECURITY**
Is something suspicious?
- EXPERIENCE**
Is the user experience good?

The more visibility we have, the faster we can respond.

So monitoring helps us prevent problems before they affect customers?



HOW IT WORKS



REMEMBER

- Always check the dashboards first.
- Understand the baseline before reacting.
- Correlate alerts before taking action.
- Ask questions. Stay curious.
- Your attention protects our customers.



TOOLS WE USE



Got it! Monitoring gives us the visibility we need to keep everything running smoothly.



VISIBILITY PREVENTS DOWNTIME.



MONITOR



DETECT



RESPOND



RESOLVE



IMPROVE

2

EPISODE 3: ALERT PRIORITY LEVELS

Not all alerts are the same. Understanding priority levels helps us respond faster to what matters most.

Focus on impact.
Act with urgency.
Protect the network.

Every alert has a priority. Let's break it down.

The priority tells us how fast we need to respond.

ALERT CONSOLE

TIME	PRIORITY	ALERT	SOURCE
09:14:32	P1	Core Router R1 - Down	Network
09:15:07	P2	High Packet Loss - MPLS Link	Network
09:16:45	P3	High CPU - Server APP01	Server
09:18:22	P4	Interface Up/Down - Sw-24	Network
09:19:05	P5	Login Failure - User Account	Security

ALERT PRIORITY LEVELS EXPLAINED

			EXAMPLES	RESPONSE TIME	OUR GOAL
P1 CRITICAL	!	Critical impact. Major outage or service down.	- Core network down - Site offline - Critical service unavailable - Major security breach	🕒 15 MIN	Immediate response. Engage bridge and escalate immediately.
P2 MAJOR	!	High impact. Service degraded or at risk.	- High packet loss - VPN down for users - Major performance issues - Redundancy failure	🕒 1 HOUR	Respond quickly. Diagnose and restore service as fast as possible.
P3 MINOR	!	Medium impact. Limited users affected.	- High CPU/Memory - Non-critical service issues - Intermittent connectivity - Alert thresholds breached	🕒 4 HOURS	Investigate and resolve during normal operation.
P4 LOW	i	Low impact. Minimal or no user impact.	- Interface up/down - Configuration warnings - Device reboot - Informational alerts	🕒 12 HOURS	Address as time allows. Monitor for changes.
P5 INFO	✓	Informational. No action required.	- Successful logins - Scheduled backups - System notifications - Routine updates	🕒 24 HOURS	No immediate action. For awareness and records.

PRIORITY GUIDELINES

- ✓ Understand the business impact.
- ✓ Check how many users are affected.
- ✓ Check if the service is down or degraded.
- ✓ Check if there is a security risk.
- ✓ When in doubt, escalate.
- ✓ Update the ticket with accurate details.

BUSINESS IMPACT SCALE



HIGH IMPACT
Many users affected.
Business operations stopped.



MEDIUM IMPACT
Some users affected.
Operations degraded.



LOW IMPACT
Few users affected.
No major business impact.

The right priority gets the right attention.

It helps us protect our customers and the network.



REMEMBER:
Right priority.
Right response.
Right outcome.



IDENTIFY
the alert



ASSESS
the impact



SET
the priority



ACT
with urgency



FOLLOW UP
and close

WE DON'T JUST SEE ALERTS.
WE UNDERSTAND THEM.
WE ACT.
THAT'S **THE FIRESIDE WAY.**



THE FIRESIDE WAY

NOC TEAM EDITION

EPISODE 4: RESPONDING TO ALERTS

A fast and accurate first response sets the tone for a successful resolution. Follow the steps. Trust the process.

Respond quickly.
Respond correctly.

An alert just came in. Let's follow the process and get started.

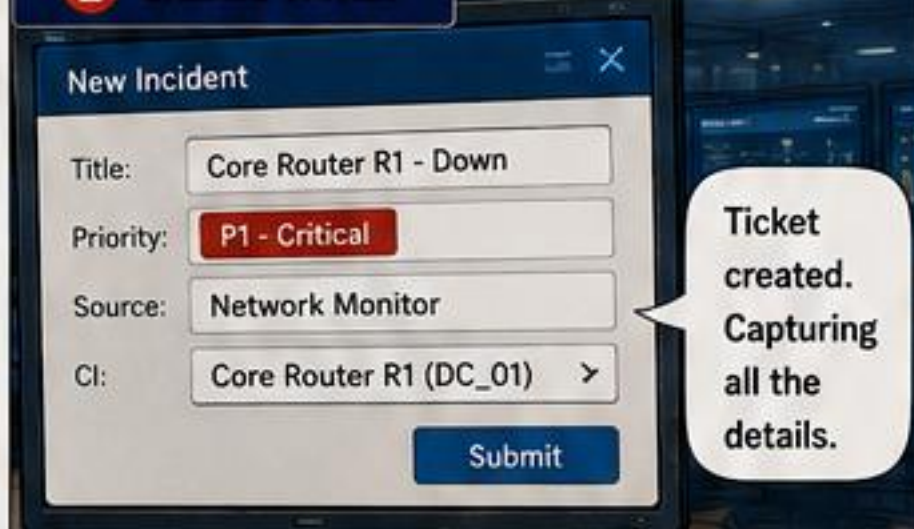
THE FIRST RESPONSE PROCESS

- 1 ALERT RECEIVED**
Alert is triggered by the monitoring system.
- 2 CREATE TICKET**
Log the alert in the ticketing system with all details.
- 3 INITIAL INVESTIGATION**
Verify the alert. Check the device, service, and recent events.
- 4 VERIFY & CONFIRM**
Confirm if the issue is real and determine the impact.
- 5 ESCALATE IF NEEDED**
If the issue is critical or beyond your scope, escalate to the right team.
- 6 UPDATE & COMMUNICATE**
Update the ticket and inform stakeholders as required.
- 7 CONTINUE MONITORING**
Monitor the issue until resolved and close the ticket accurately.

1 ALERT RECEIVED



2 CREATE TICKET



3 INITIAL INVESTIGATION



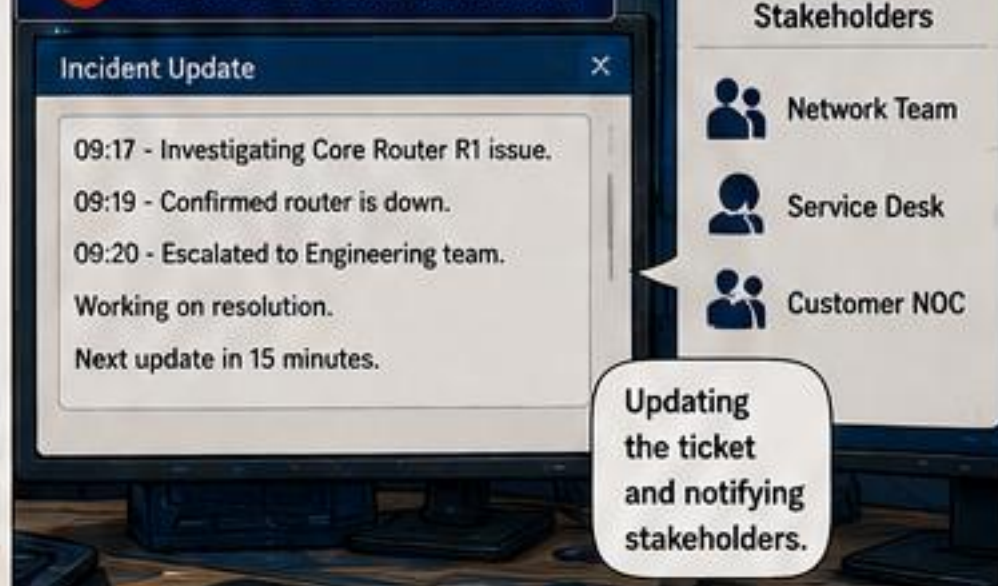
4 VERIFY & CONFIRM



5 ESCALATE IF NEEDED



6 UPDATE & COMMUNICATE



7 CONTINUE MONITORING



KEY REMINDERS

- ✓ Acknowledge alerts immediately.
- ✓ Gather the facts before taking action.
- ✓ Document everything.
- ✓ Communicate early and often.
- ✓ Escalate when needed – don't wait.
- ✓ Stay calm, stay focused, stay professional.



FIRST RESPONSE
MAKES THE DIFFERENCE.

FROM ALERT TO ACTION



ALERT



TICKET



INVESTIGATE



VERIFY



ESCALATE



COMMUNICATE



RESOLVE

FAST RESPONSE. RIGHT ACTION. BETTER OUTCOMES. THAT'S THE FIRESIDE WAY.

EPISODE 5: INCIDENT TROUBLESHOOTING

Troubleshooting is more than fixing. It's about finding the root cause and restoring service the right way.

Understand the problem before fixing it.



1 IDENTIFY THE ISSUE



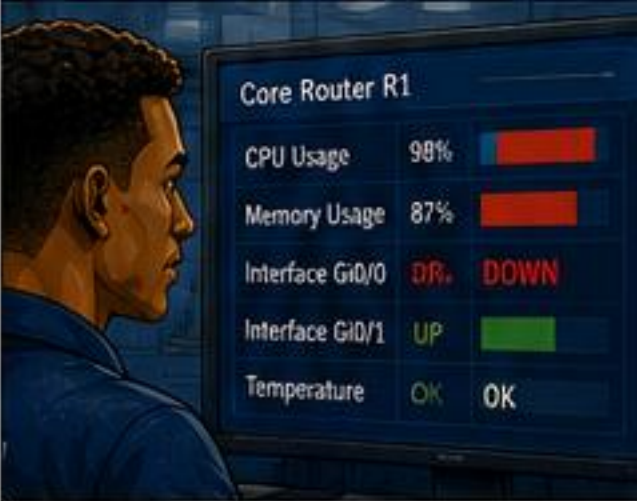
Review the alert details, impacted services, and affected users. Confirm the scope of the issue.

2 CHECK CONNECTIVITY



Verify basic connectivity. Ping gateways, check interfaces, and validate routes.

3 CHECK DEVICE HEALTH



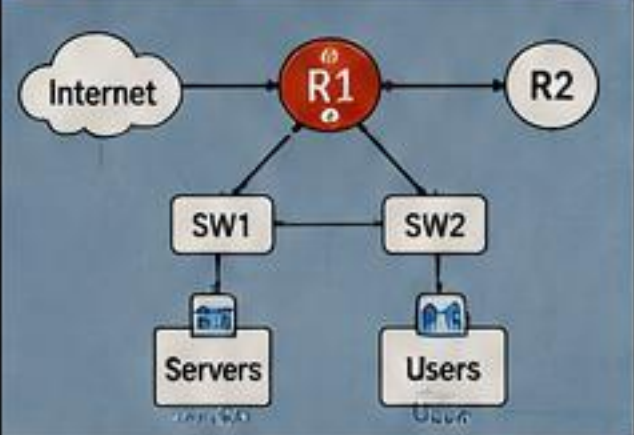
Check device status: CPU, memory, interfaces, power, and logs.

4 REVIEW LOGS & EVENTS



Analyze logs and recent events. Look for errors, flaps, or anomalies around the time of the incident.

5 ISOLATE THE PROBLEM



Determine where the issue is. Is it the device, link, configuration, power, or upstream system?

6 TEST & VALIDATE



Run tests, verify findings, and validate with evidence. Don't skip verification.

7 IDENTIFY ROOT CAUSE



Pinpoint the root cause, not just the symptom. Document what caused the outage.

8 IMPLEMENT THE FIX



Apply the resolution based on the root cause. Coordinate with engineers if needed.

9 VERIFY RESOLUTION



Confirm the service is restored. Check alerts, dashboards, and customer impact.

10 DOCUMENT EVERYTHING



Update the ticket with steps taken, findings, root cause, and resolution. Good notes help future you!

11 COMMUNICATE & CLOSE



Notify stakeholders and customers. Close the ticket after final confirmation.

TROUBLESHOOTING BEST PRACTICES

- Follow a systematic approach.
- Ask questions. Challenge assumptions.
- Document as you go.
- Collaborate and escalate when needed.
- Focus on root cause, not quick fixes.

TOOLS WE USE



REMEMBER

Patience. Process. Precision.
That's how we solve it right.



UNDERSTAND THE PROBLEM. FIND THE CAUSE. RESTORE THE SERVICE. THAT'S THE FIRESIDE WAY.

THE FIRESIDE WAY

NOC TEAM EDITION



EPISODE 6: CUSTOMER COMMUNICATION

Clear, timely, and honest communication builds trust and reduces frustration.

Your words matter as much as your actions.

Communication builds trust.



CUSTOMER

Our internet is down. What's happening?

NOC ANALYST

Thank you for reaching out. We're checking now and will update you shortly.

09:14 AM ✓



COMMUNICATION BEST PRACTICES

 BE CLEAR Use simple, understandable language.	 BE TIMELY Provide updates regularly, even if there's no new information.	 BE HONEST Share what you know. Don't guess or give false assurances.	 BE EMPATHETIC Understand the customer's impact and show you care.	 BE PROFESSIONAL Stay calm, polite, and solution focused.	 BE CONSISTENT Align messages across all teams and channels.
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THE COMMUNICATION JOURNEY

1 INITIAL ACKNOWLEDGEMENT Thanks for contacting us. We've received your alert and are checking now. 09:15 AM ✓ Acknowledge quickly. Let the customer know their issue is important.	2 INVESTIGATION UPDATE We are currently investigating a network issue affecting your service. 09:22 AM ✓ Provide regular updates. Share what you're doing and any known impact.	3 ONGOING STATUS Our engineers have identified the cause and are working on a fix now. 09:35 AM ✓ Keep them informed about progress. Set expectations.	4 RESOLUTION UPDATE The issue has been resolved. Service is restoring now. 10:02 AM ✓ Inform customers when the issue is resolved and service is normalizing.	5 FOLLOW UP Can you confirm if your service is working as expected now? 10:15 AM ✓ Confirm service restoration and customer satisfaction.	6 CLOSURE & THANK YOU Thank you for your patience. We're here if you need anything else. 10:18 AM ✓ Close the loop. Thank the customer for their patience.
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COMMUNICATION CHANNELS	EXAMPLE COMMUNICATION TEMPLATE	WHAT TO AVOID
Phone Calls For urgent or critical updates Email For detailed updates and reports SMS / Text Alerts For quick notifications Customer Portal For status updates and announcements Live Chat For real-time support	Subject: Update on Your Service [Incident ID] Hello [Customer Name], We are currently experiencing [brief description of issue] affecting [services impacted]. Our team is working to resolve this as quickly as possible. Next update: [time] Incident ID: [number] Thank you for your patience. – Fireside NOC Team	No updates Overpromising Blame or excuses Technical jargon Inconsistent information REMEMBER Happy customers come from great communication and reliable service.

THE IMPACT OF GOOD COMMUNICATION

BUILDS TRUST	REDUCES FRUSTRATION	IMPROVES SATISFACTION	STRENGTHENS RELATIONSHIPS	ENHANCES REPUTATION
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CLEAR COMMUNICATION. STRONGER CONNECTIONS. BETTER OUTCOMES. **THE FIRESIDE WAY.**

EPISODE 7: ESCALATION PROCEDURES

Escalation ensures the right people are involved at the right time to resolve issues faster and minimize impact.

Escalate early,
Escalate smart,
Escalate the right way.



WHEN TO ESCALATE

- ✓ When the impact is high or increasing
- ✓ When resolution exceeds your authority
- ✓ When the issue is not resolved within the expected time
- ✓ When specialized skills or access are required
- ✓ When multiple teams or vendors are involved
- ✓ When the customer is highly impacted or escalated

ESCALATION MATRIX

PRIORITY	LEVEL 1 (ANALYST)	LEVEL 2 (SENIOR ENGINEER)	LEVEL 3 (TEAM LEAD)	LEVEL 4 (MANAGER)	LEVEL 5 (DIRECTOR / EXEC)
P1 CRITICAL	NOC Analyst 	Senior Engineer 	NOC Team Lead 	NOC Manager 	Operations Director / Executive
P2 MAJOR	NOC Analyst 	Senior Engineer 	NOC Team Lead 	NOC Manager 	Operations Director / Executive
P3 MINOR	NOC Analyst 	Senior Engineer (On-Call) 	NOC Team Lead (If needed)	NOC Manager (If needed)	—
P4/P5 LOW / INFO	NOC Analyst 	Senior Engineer (Optional)	—	—	—

Escalate based on impact, urgency, and required expertise — not just ticket age.

THINK BEFORE YOU ESCALATE



BE PREPARED TO SHARE:

- ✓ What is the issue?
- ✓ What steps have you taken?
- ✓ What is the impact?
- ✓ What do you need?
- ✓ Any relevant logs or screenshots?

ESCALATION FLOW

- 1. DETECT & ANALYZE**
Identify and investigate the issue.
- 2. ATTEMPT RESOLUTION**
Take all steps within your scope.
- 3. IDENTIFY NEED**
Determine the right team or resource.
- 4. ESCALATE**
Provide all relevant information and impact details.
- 5. FOLLOW UP**
Stay engaged until the issue is resolved.

KEY PRINCIPLES

- ESCALATE EARLY**
Early escalation reduces impact and speeds up resolution.
- ESCALATE SMART**
Involve the right team, not every team.
- CLEAR & COMPLETE INFORMATION**
Good information saves time and prevents back-and-forth.
- OWNERSHIP DOESN'T END YOU ESCALATE**
Stay involved and follow through until resolution.
- DOCUMENT EVERYTHING**
Update the ticket and capture all escalation steps.

ESCALATION CHANNELS

- TICKET SYSTEM**
Create escalation ticket with proper priority.
- PHONE CALL / VOICE**
For urgent or high-impact issues.
- CHAT / TEAMS**
For quick coordination and updates.
- ESCALATION BRIDGE**
For major incidents and war rooms.
- VENDOR SUPPORT PORTAL**
For third-party or vendor escalations.

ESCALATION IN ACTION



REMEMBER

Escalation is not a handover.
It's a team effort to restore service.



RIGHT PEOPLE



RIGHT TIME



RIGHT INFO



RIGHT ACTION



BETTER OUTCOMES

ESCALATE WITH CONFIDENCE. COMMUNICATE WITH CLARITY. RESOLVE TOGETHER.

THAT'S THE FIRESIDE WAY.

EPISODE 8: SHIFT HANDOVER PROCESS

A smooth handover keeps our operations seamless and our customers protected.

Clear today.
Confident tomorrow.
Never miss a thing.



WHY IT MATTERS

-  Ensures continuity of operations
-  Prevents missing critical issues
-  Reduces risk and errors
-  Improves team accountability
-  Builds trust and reliability

THE SHIFT HANDOVER CHECKLIST

1 REVIEW OPEN INCIDENTS

- Discuss all open incidents
- Current status
- Actions taken
- Next steps
- Impact level



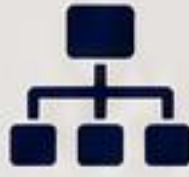
2 PENDING TASKS & FOLLOW-UPS

- Outstanding tasks
- Pending approvals
- Engineering actions
- Customer updates due



3 SYSTEM & SERVICE STATUS

- Network overview
- Critical alerts
- Performance issues
- Maintenance windows
- Service degradations



4 CUSTOMER COMMUNICATIONS

- Recent customer interactions
- Commitments made
- Upcoming updates required



5 SECURITY & RISK NOTES

- Security alerts
- Potential threats
- Vulnerabilities
- Access or policy changes



6 SPECIAL NOTES

- Anything unusual
- Watch-outs
- Tips or context
- Lessons learned



THE HANDOVER PROCESS

1 PREPARE EARLY



Document everything before the handover. Don't wait until the last minute.

2 MEET & CONNECT



Start on time. Be focused and ready to share.

3 SHARE CLEARLY



Explain the situation clearly and in the right order.

4 ASK & CLARIFY



Encourage questions. Clarify anything unclear.

5 CONFIRM UNDERSTANDING



Confirm that the receiving analyst understands everything.

6 DOCUMENT & CLOSE



Update the tickets and handover log. Close the handover properly.

HANDOVER LOG TEMPLATE

Date: Shift From:
Analyst: Shift To:
Analyst:

CATEGORY	DETAILS / NOTES
Open Incidents	
Pending Tasks	
System Status	
Customer Updates	
Security Notes	
Special Notes	

BEST PRACTICES

- ✓ Be prepared and organized
- ✓ Communicate clearly and concisely
- ✓ Share the full context, not just the facts
- ✓ Listen actively and ask questions
- ✓ Stay professional and positive
- ✓ Document everything
- ✓ Respect each other's time

GOLDEN RULE

Would you feel comfortable leaving the shift in this state?



WHAT TO AVOID

- ✗ Rushing the handover
- ✗ Skipping important details
- ✗ Assuming the other person knows
- ✗ Leaving unanswered questions
- ✗ Incomplete documentation
- ✗ Interruptions and distractions



REMEMBER

A good handover is a sign of a great professional. It protects our customers and our team.

THE HANDOVER COMMITMENT



WE TAKE OWNERSHIP



WE COMMUNICATE CLEARLY



WE PROTECT OUR CUSTOMERS



WE DOCUMENT EVERYTHING



WE SUPPORT EACH OTHER

EPISODE 9: CYBERSECURITY ALERTS

Cyber threats are real and constant. Our monitoring, awareness, and quick response keep our customers safe.

See it. Report it.
Stop it.
Secure it.



WHAT IS A CYBERSECURITY ALERT?



A cybersecurity alert is any detection of suspicious, malicious, or unauthorized activity that could threaten our systems, data, or customers.

Early detection helps us prevent breaches and minimize impact.

COMMON TYPES OF CYBERSECURITY ALERTS

UNAUTHORIZED ACCESS



Someone trying to access systems, accounts, or resources without permission.

MALWARE DETECTION



Malicious software detected on endpoints, servers, or in network traffic.

PORT / SERVICE SCANS



Suspicious scanning activity looking for open ports or vulnerabilities.

BRUTE FORCE ATTACKS



Repeated login attempts trying to guess passwords or exploit weaknesses.

POLICY VIOLATIONS



Users or devices violating security policies or configuration rules.

DATA EXFILTRATION



Unusual data transfers that may indicate theft or leakage.

RESPONDING TO A CYBERSECURITY ALERT

1 DETECT



Alert triggered by our security tools. Review the details immediately.

2 ANALYZE



Investigate the alert. Check source, target, user, and activity behavior.

3 VALIDATE



Determine if the alert is a real threat or a false positive.

4 CONTAIN



If confirmed, isolate affected systems or block malicious activity.

5 ESCALATE



Notify the appropriate team based on the severity and impact.

6 ERADICATE



Remove the threat, close vulnerabilities, and secure the environment.

7 RECOVER & MONITOR



Restore normal operations and continue monitoring closely.

ESCALATION & COMMUNICATION

ESCALATION PATH



COMMUNICATION FLOW

- Notify the right people at the right time.
- Use clear, accurate, and timely updates.
- Document all actions and communications.
- Keep customers informed when necessary.

KEY PRINCIPLES

- ASSUME BREACH**
Act with urgency. Validate fast.
- LIMIT THE DAMAGE**
Contain first, then investigate.
- PRESERVE EVIDENCE**
Do not delete logs or artifacts.
- STAY INFORMED**
Threats evolve. Stay updated.
- TEAMWORK**
We are stronger together.

BEST PRACTICES

- Keep systems and tools updated
- Use strong passwords & MFA
- Monitor logs and alerts 24/7
- Follow least privilege access
- Report anything suspicious
- Back up critical data regularly
- Run vulnerability scans routinely
- Train and stay security-aware



REMEMBER

Security is everyone's responsibility. Be alert. Be smart. Be secure.

TOOLS WE USE



SIEM



SPLUNK



MICROSOFT SENTINEL



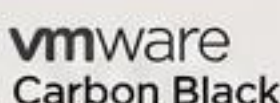
PALO ALTO FIREWALL



CROWDSTRIKE



WIRESHARK



CARBON BLACK



DETECT EARLY



RESPOND FAST



PROTECT ALWAYS



SECURE TOGETHER

STRONGER DEFENSES. SAFER CUSTOMERS. THAT'S THE FIRESIDE WAY.

EPISODE 10: NETWORK OUTAGE RESPONSE

When the network goes down, every second counts. A calm mind, clear steps, and strong teamwork get us through it.

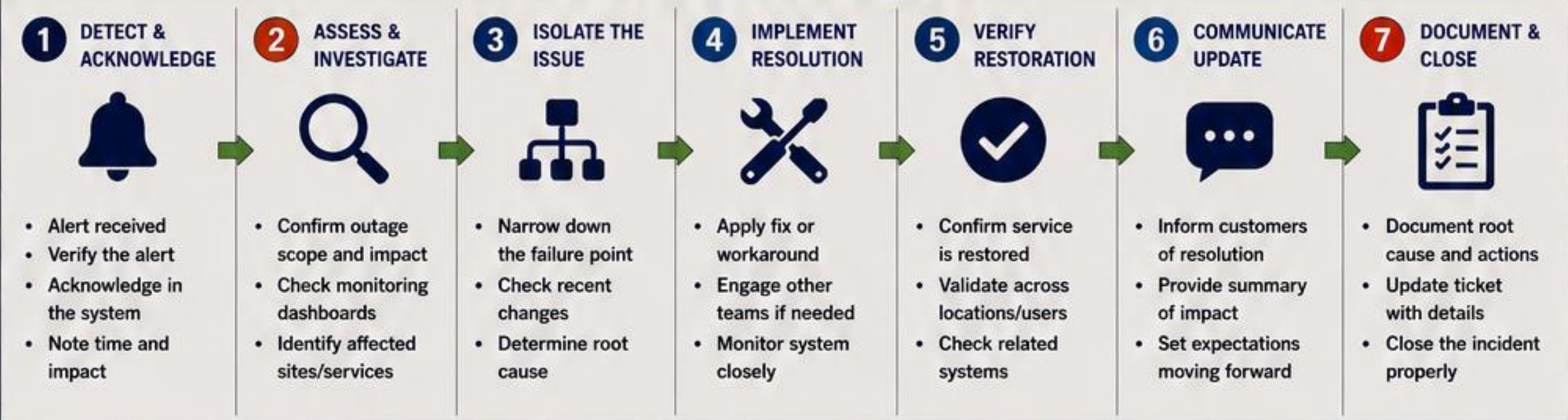
Stay focused.
Follow the process.
Restore with purpose.



COMMON OUTAGE IMPACTS

- Loss of internet connectivity
- Inability to access critical applications
- VoIP / phone system disruptions
- VPN / remote access down
- Monitoring and alerting gaps
- Customer and business impact

OUTAGE RESPONSE PROCESS



OUTAGE TRIAGE CHECKLIST	IMPACT SEVERITY GUIDE		CUSTOMER COMMUNICATION TEMPLATES	
✓ What is down? ✓ Who is affected? ✓ When did it start? ✓ What is the business impact? ✓ Any recent changes or maintenance? ✓ Is this a known issue? ✓ What is the suspected cause? ✓ What is the next best step?	SEV 1 CRITICAL Major outage affecting many customers or core services. Immediate response required. SEV 2 MAJOR Significant impact to multiple users or locations. Urgent response required. SEV 3 MINOR Limited impact to some users. Standard response. SEV 4 INFO Minimal or no customer impact. Informational or monitoring.	 OUTAGE UPDATE We are currently investigating a network outage affecting [service / location]. Our team is working to restore service as quickly as possible. Next update by [time].  RESOLUTION UPDATE The network issue has been resolved. Services are restoring and we are monitoring to ensure stability. Thank you for your patience.  POST-INCIDENT SUMMARY We experienced a network outage on [date/time] affecting [services]. The issue has been resolved. Root cause: [brief summary]. Preventive actions: [actions taken].		

COMMUNICATION CHANNELS	ESCALATION PATH	BEST PRACTICES	WHAT TO AVOID
- Phone Calls For urgent or critical updates - SMS / Text Alerts For quick notifications - Email For detailed updates and reports - Customer Portal For status updates and announcements - Live Chat For real-time customer support - Teams / Slack For internal coordination	NOC ANALYST Initial investigation and impact assessment ↓ SENIOR ENGINEER Advanced troubleshooting and resolution ↓ NOC TEAM LEAD Oversees response and communications ↓ OPERATIONS MANAGER Major incidents and cross-team coordination ↓ DIRECTOR / EXECUTIVE Executive-level incidents and communications	- Communicate early and often - Provide accurate and timely updates - Stay calm and follow the process - Collaborate and support each other - Learn and improve after every incident	- Speculating on root cause - Providing unclear or vague updates - Blaming teams or vendors - Closing without proper validation - Skipping post-incident documentation

KEY REMINDERS

- CUSTOMERS COME FIRST
- PROCESS DRIVES RESULTS
- TEAMWORK MAKES THE DIFFERENCE
- EVERY INCIDENT IS A LEARNING OPPORTUNITY
- STAY CALM. STAY FOCUSED. RESTORE SERVICE.

EPISODE 11: ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS

Root Cause Analysis helps us find the real cause of an issue so we can fix it right, prevent recurrence, and improve continuously.

Don't stop at the symptom. Find the cause. Drive the solution.

Understanding why it happened helps us make sure it doesn't happen again.

ROOT CAUSE FOUND

SYMPTOM
(What happened)

CAUSES
(Why it happened)

ROOT CAUSE
(The underlying issue)

KEY BENEFITS

- Prevents recurring incidents
- Improves system reliability and performance
- Reduces operational costs and downtime
- Builds team knowledge and accountability
- Drives continuous improvement

THE ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS PROCESS



COMMON RCA TOOLS

CAUSE CATEGORIES (PEOPLE, PROCESS, TECHNOLOGY, ENVIRONMENT)

EXAMPLE: 5 WHYS

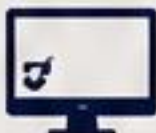
- 5 WHYS**
Ask "Why?" repeatedly until the root cause is revealed.
- FISHBONE DIAGRAM**
Map potential causes across key categories to find the root.
- CHANGE ANALYSIS**
Review recent changes to identify connections to the incident.
- TIMELINE ANALYSIS**
Build a timeline to identify key events and patterns.
- FAULT TREE ANALYSIS**
Work backward from the event to identify contributing factors.

PEOPLE

PROCESS

TECHNOLOGY

ENVIRONMENT



- Lack of training
- Human error
- Miscommunication
- Staffing issues

- Inadequate procedures
- Poor documentation
- Approval gaps
- Policy not followed

- Software defects
- Misconfiguration
- Hardware failure
- Capacity limits

- Power issues
- Network instability
- Temperature
- Physical security

- 1

Why did the application go offline?
The database was unreachable.
- 2

Why was the database unreachable?
The database server crashed.
- 3

Why did the server crash?
It ran out of memory.
- 4

Why did it run out of memory?
A memory leak in the application.
- 5

Why was the memory leak not detected?
Monitoring did not alert on memory usage.

ROOT CAUSE:
Monitoring gap allowed memory issue to go unnoticed.

RCA DOCUMENTATION TEMPLATE

BEST PRACTICES

PITFALLS TO AVOID

Incident ID: Date:

Analyst:

Reviewers:

SECTION	DETAILS
Problem Statement	
Impact Summary	
Timeline of Events	
Data Collected	
Potential Causes	
Root Cause	
Corrective Actions	
Preventive Actions	
Lessons Learned	

- Stay objective and focus on facts
- Involve the right people early
- Consider all possible causes
- Don't blame—focus on solutions
- Validate the root cause with evidence
- Document thoroughly
- Share and apply lessons learned
- Continuously improve processes and monitoring

- Jumping to conclusions
- Stopping at the symptom
- Blaming individuals
- Ignoring data
- Not involving key stakeholders
- Poor documentation
- Not implementing preventive actions
- Failing to follow up

“

The goal of Root Cause Analysis is not to find fault, but to find the truth and prevent it from happening again.

FROM ANALYSIS TO IMPROVEMENT



- REMEMBER**
A thorough Root Cause Analysis today prevents tomorrow's outage. Curiosity. Clarity. Commitment.

STAY CURIOUS
Ask why until you know the truth.

BE THOROUGH
Use data. Follow the process.

THINK LONG TERM
Solve the cause, not just the issue.

GET BETTER EVERY DAY
Learn, share, improve, repeat.

EPISODE 12: MONITORING PERFORMANCE METRICS

Metrics turn data into insight and insight into action.

Measure what matters.
Improve what you measure.
Deliver what counts.



WHY MONITOR METRICS?

- Understand performance and trends
- Identify issues early
- Drive continuous improvement
- Demonstrate value and accountability
- Support better decisions and planning

KEY NOC PERFORMANCE METRICS

1 ALERT VOLUME Total number of alerts received in a given period. WHY IT MATTERS Shows system noise and workload.	2 MTTA (MEAN TIME TO ACKNOWLEDGE) Average time from alert to acknowledgment. WHY IT MATTERS Measures responsiveness to potential issues.	3 MTTR (MEAN TIME TO RESOLVE) Average time to fully resolve an incident. WHY IT MATTERS Indicates efficiency of resolution.	4 SERVICE AVAILABILITY Percentage of time services are available and operational. WHY IT MATTERS Reflects reliability experienced by users.	5 FIRST CONTACT RESOLUTION (FCR) Percentage of incidents resolved on first contact. WHY IT MATTERS Shows effectiveness of support and knowledge.	6 ESCALATION RATE Percentage of incidents escalated to higher tier. WHY IT MATTERS Highlights complexity and ownership gaps.	7 REOPEN RATE Percentage of incidents reopened after closure. WHY IT MATTERS Indicates quality of resolution.
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DASHBOARD EXAMPLE



TIP: Customize dashboards for your team, stakeholders, and operational goals.

PERFORMANCE TARGETS (EXAMPLES)

- MTTA (P1 Alerts) ≤ 2 minutes
- MTTR (P1 Incidents) ≤ 30 minutes
- Service Availability ≥ 99.9%
- First Contact Resolution ≥ 80%
- Escalation Rate ≤ 15%
- Reopen Rate ≤ 5%

TREND ANALYSIS GUIDE

- LOOK FOR TRENDS**
Are metrics improving, stable, or declining?
- CORRELATE EVENTS**
Match metric changes with incidents, deployments, or changes.
- IDENTIFY PATTERNS**
Find recurring issues by time, service, team, or environment.
- TAKE ACTION**
Use insights to adjust processes, training, tools, or resources.
- MEASURE AGAIN**
Track impact and continue the improvement cycle.

DATA QUALITY MATTERS

- ✓ Ensure accurate alert configuration and tagging
- ✓ Keep time sources synchronized
- ✓ Standardize incident categories and priorities
- ✓ Document resolutions clearly
- ✓ Validate data regularly
- ✓ Trust the data. Improve the data.



REVIEW CADENCE

DAILY

Review key metrics and outliers

WEEKLY

Analyze trends and patterns

MONTHLY

Report performance and outcomes

QUARTERLY

Evaluate goals and set improvements

REPORTING & COMMUNICATION

- Share metrics with the right audience
- Use visualizations that are clear and simple
- Highlight wins and areas for improvement
- Tell the story behind the numbers
- Be transparent and action-oriented

BEST PRACTICES

- ✓ Focus on leading and lagging indicators
- ✓ Balance volume and outcome metrics
- ✓ Align metrics with business objectives
- ✓ Continuously refine and evolve metrics
- ✓ Celebrate progress and learn from setbacks

PITFALLS TO AVOID

- ✗ Tracking too many metrics
- ✗ Focusing on activity, not outcomes
- ✗ Ignoring context behind the numbers
- ✗ Comparing teams unfairly
- ✗ Failing to act on insights

REMEMBER

Great teams don't just respond to alerts—they measure, learn, and get better every day.

MEASURE WHAT MATTERS

UNDERSTAND THE INSIGHTS

TAKE ACTION TO IMPROVE

DELIVER VALUE TOGETHER

THE FIRESIDE WAY

NOC TEAM EDITION



EPISODE 13: TEAMWORK IN THE NOC

We are stronger together. Great teamwork in the NOC means faster solutions, happier customers, and a better workplace.

One team.
One goal.
Every customer.



WHY TEAMWORK MATTERS

- Faster resolution of incidents
- Better decision-making and resource use
- Stronger support for our customers
- Positive team culture and job satisfaction
- Continuous improvement and shared success

OUR TEAMWORK PRINCIPLES

TRUST



We trust each other to do the right thing and have each other's back.

COMMUNICATION



We share information clearly, concisely, and in a timely way.

COLLABORATION



We work together, share knowledge, and solve problems as a team.

ACCOUNTABILITY



We take ownership, follow through, and hold ourselves accountable.

RESPECT



We value everyone, listen actively, and treat each other with respect.

SUPPORT



We help each other succeed and celebrate our wins together.

NOC TEAM ROLES (WE ALL PLAY A PART)

- NOC ANALYST**
Monitor, detect, and respond to alerts and incidents.
- SENIOR ENGINEER**
Provide advanced troubleshooting and technical expertise.
- TEAM LEAD**
Coordinate the team, prioritize work, and escalate when needed.
- ESCALATION MANAGER**
Manage escalations and communicate with stakeholders.
- KNOWLEDGE CHAMPION**
Maintain documentation and share best practices.
- QUALITY CHAMPION**
Promote quality, process adherence, and continuous improvement.

EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

- BE CLEAR & CONCISE**
Use simple, direct language.
- SHARE CONTEXT**
Provide the who, what, when, where, why, and impact.
- ACTIVE LISTENING**
Listen to understand, not just to respond.
- CONFIRM & CLARIFY**
Repeat back key information and ask questions.
- KEEP EVERYONE INFORMED**
Update your team—especially when things change.

COLLABORATION IN ACTION

- Huddle at the start of each shift.
- Share updates on open incidents and priorities.
- Ask for help early—no one has all the answers.
- Document lessons learned and share knowledge.
- Cover for teammates and communicate absences.

COLLABORATION TOOLS WE USE

- TEAMS / SLACK**
Chat, channels, and calls
- TICKET SYSTEM**
Track, assign, and update
- WIKI / KB**
Share knowledge and solutions
- DASHBOARDS**
Monitor and share real-time status
- SHIFT LOGS**
Document and share insights
- WHITEBOARD**
Plan, diagram, and brainstorm

RESOLVING CONFLICTS

- 1. RECOGNIZE**
Acknowledge the issue early.
- 2. LISTEN**
Hear each other with respect.
- 3. DISCUSS**
Focus on the facts and the impact.
- 4. AGREE**
Find a solution together.
- 5. MOVE FORWARD**
Learn and improve as a team.

“Talent wins games, but teamwork and intelligence win championships.”

– Michael Jordan

BUILDING A STRONG NOC CULTURE

- BE POSITIVE**
Bring good energy. Encourage others.
- GIVE & RECEIVE FEEDBACK**
Be constructive and open to growth.
- RECOGNIZE & CELEBRATE**
Acknowledge wins—big and small.
- SUPPORT WORK-LIFE BALANCE**
Take care of yourself and your team.
- LIVE THE FIRESIDE WAY**
Lead by example every day.

SHIFT HANDOFF AS A TEAM

- Prepare together for a smooth handover.
- Share status, context, and open items clearly.
- Ask questions and confirm understanding.
- Document everything in the log.
- Support the incoming team.



A good handoff is a team effort. It sets our next team up for success.

TEAM SUCCESS INDICATORS

- High service availability
- Low incident recurrence
- Positive customer feedback
- Strong team engagement
- Continuous learning and improvement

WE WIN TOGETHER



When we support each other, communicate well, and stay focused on our customers, there is no limit to what we can achieve.

OUR COMMITMENT TO EACH OTHER

- I WILL COMMUNICATE OPENLY AND HONESTLY.
- I WILL RESPECT EVERY TEAM MEMBER.
- I WILL SUPPORT MY TEAM AND ASK FOR HELP WHEN NEEDED.
- I WILL SHARE KNOWLEDGE AND HELP OTHERS GROW.
- I WILL DO MY PART TO DELIVER EXCELLENT SERVICE.

ONE TEAM. ONE PURPOSE. EXCEPTIONAL SERVICE. THAT'S THE FIRESIDE WAY.

EPISODE 14: CUSTOMER ESCALATION MANAGEMENT

Escalations are opportunities to show our commitment to customers. Listen carefully. Act quickly. Communicate clearly. Follow through.

Resolve the issue.
Restore confidence.
Strengthen trust.



WHY IT MATTERS

- Turns negative experiences into positive outcomes
- Protects customer trust and our reputation
- Drives customer loyalty and retention
- Improves processes and prevents repeat issues
- Delivers exceptional customer experience

CUSTOMER ESCALATION MANAGEMENT PROCESS



ESCALATION PRIORITY GUIDE		CUSTOMER COMMUNICATION BEST PRACTICES		WHAT TO SAY	
P1 CRITICAL	Major outage or business impact Affects critical operations or many users Immediate response required	BE RESPONSIVE Acknowledge quickly and stay engaged.	BE CLEAR Use simple language. Avoid jargon.	SAY THIS "Thank you for bringing this to our attention." "I understand how important this is." "I will stay with you until this is resolved." "Here is what we know right now..." "We are working to resolve this as quickly as possible." "Thank you for your patience."	AVOID THIS "That's not our problem." "It's working on our end." "I don't know." "You'll have to wait." "Calm down." - Making promises you can't keep.
P2 HIGH	Significant impact to services Affects a large group of users Urgent response required	BE TRANSPARENT Share what we know, what we don't, and what we're doing.	BE CONSISTENT Provide regular updates at agreed intervals.		
P3 MEDIUM	Limited impact or workaround available Affects some users Respond within agreed timeframe	BE EMPATHETIC Understand their impact. Show you care.			
P4 LOW	Minimal impact or request for information Affects individual users Respond as resources allow				

ESCALATION LEVELS & PATH	ESCALATION CHECKLIST	TOOLS & RESOURCES
LEVEL 1 NOC ANALYST First point of contact. Attempt initial resolution. LEVEL 2 SENIOR ENGINEER Advanced troubleshooting and resolution. LEVEL 3 NOC TEAM LEAD Resource coordination and cross-team engagement. LEVEL 4 OPERATIONS MANAGER Major incident management and customer advocacy. LEVEL 5 DIRECTOR / EXECUTIVE Executive escalation and strategic communication.	☒ I acknowledged the escalation immediately. ☒ I captured accurate details and impact. ☒ I communicated ownership to the customer. ☒ I set clear expectations and next update time. ☒ I provided regular, proactive updates. ☒ I resolved the issue and validated with the customer. ☒ I confirmed customer satisfaction. ☒ I documented the resolution and root cause. ☒ I shared learnings and improvement opportunities.	TICKET SYSTEM Track and update all escalation tickets. KNOWLEDGE BASE Find solutions and past resolutions. COMMUNICATION TEMPLATES Use approved templates for updates. STAKEHOLDER DIRECTORY Quick access to key contacts. POST-INCIDENT REVIEW GUIDE Capture lessons and drive improvement.

ESCALATION WARNING SIGNS	TURN NEGATIVES INTO POSITIVES	COMMON PITFALLS	REMEMBER
- Customer is repeatedly asking for updates - Slow or no communication - Multiple tickets for the same issue - Customer expresses frustration or dissatisfaction - Business impact is increasing	- Listen actively - Act with urgency - Communicate with care - Deliver results - Follow through	- Delayed acknowledgment - Lack of clear ownership - Poor or infrequent updates - Overpromising - Closing without validation - Not capturing learnings	REMEMBER The goal is not just to resolve the issue. The goal is to leave the customer better informed, more confident, and stronger in their trust.

CORE PRINCIPLES

OWN IT
Take responsibility and drive it to resolution.

COMMUNICATE IT
Keep customers informed early, often, and honestly.

SOLVE IT
Find the root cause and fix it right the first time.

CONFIRM IT
Validate with the customer and close with care.

LEARN IT
Share lessons and prevent it from happening again.

RESPECT. RESPONSIBILITY. RESOLUTION. THAT'S THE FIRESIDE WAY.

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EPISODE 15: PREVENTIVE MONITORING

Preventive monitoring helps us detect issues before they impact customers. Stay ahead. Stay alert. Keep the network strong and reliable.

See it early.
Fix it early.
Prevent the issue.



We monitor proactively so our customers can stay connected confidently.

WHY PREVENTIVE MONITORING MATTERS

-  Detects issues before they cause downtime or degradation
-  Reduces incidents and customer impact
-  Improves performance and reliability
-  Reduces costs through early intervention
-  Builds trust and strengthens customer confidence

WHAT WE MONITOR

NETWORK HEALTH	PERFORMANCE	INFRASTRUCTURE	APPLICATIONS & SERVICES	SECURITY	CONFIGURATION & CHANGE HEALTH	CAPACITY & FORECASTING
						
• Device availability • Link status • Error rates • Packet loss	• Bandwidth utilization • Latency • Jitter • Response times	• CPU / Memory / Disk • Temperature • Power / Fan status • System logs	• Application uptime • Transaction success • Service dependencies • API response times	• Failed logins • Intrusion attempts • Malware alerts • Vulnerability status	• Unauthorized changes • Backup status • Compliance status • Configuration drift	• Trend analysis • Growth tracking • Resource planning • Threshold forecasting

KEY METRICS & THRESHOLDS (EXAMPLES)

METRIC	DESCRIPTION	WARNING THRESHOLD	CRITICAL THRESHOLD
Link Utilization	Percentage of bandwidth used	> 70%	> 90%
Packet Loss	Percentage of packets lost	> 1%	> 3%
Latency	Round-trip time (ms)	> 150 ms	> 250 ms
CPU Utilization	Average CPU usage	> 75%	> 90%
Memory Utilization	Average memory usage	> 80%	> 95%
Disk Utilization	Average disk usage	> 80%	> 95%
Service Availability	Percentage of uptime	< 99%	< 95%

PREVENTIVE MONITORING TOOLS

-  **NETWORK MONITORING**
Tools like PRTG, SolarWinds, or Zabbix for real-time network visibility.
-  **INFRASTRUCTURE MONITORING**
Tools like Nagios, Datadog, or Prometheus for system health.
-  **LOG MANAGEMENT**
Tools like Splunk, ELK, or Graylog for log analysis and alerting.
-  **SYNTHETIC MONITORING**
Tools like Pingdom or ThousandEyes to simulate user experience.
-  **ALERTING & NOTIFICATIONS**
Tools like Opsgenie, PagerDuty, or Microsoft Teams integrations.

THE PREVENTIVE MONITORING CYCLE



PREVENTIVE MONITORING CHECKLIST	ALERT TUNING BEST PRACTICES	MONITORING REVIEW CADENCE	THE BENEFITS WE DELIVER
✓ All critical systems are being monitored. ✓ Alerts are configured with appropriate thresholds. ✓ Monitoring dashboards are reviewed regularly. ✓ Logs are collected and analyzed. ✓ Dependencies between systems are mapped. ✓ Alerts are routed to the correct teams. ✓ Documentation and runbooks are up to date. ✓ Capacity trends are reviewed weekly. ✓ False alerts are minimized and tuned. ✓ Lessons learned are applied continuously.	✗ Set thresholds based on real-world data. ✗ Avoid overly sensitive alert conditions. ✗ Suppress known, non-actionable alerts. ✗ Group related alerts to reduce noise. ✗ Review and tune alerts regularly. ✗ Engage teams to validate alert usefulness. ✗ Track false positives and adjust. ✗ Keep alerts actionable and meaningful.	 DAILY Review alerts, incidents, and system health.  WEEKLY Review trends, capacity, and tuning needs.  MONTHLY Review reports, thresholds, and tools.  QUARTERLY Review strategy, tools, and improvement plan.	 Fewer incidents and outages  Higher network reliability  Better performance for customers  Lower operational costs  Stronger customer satisfaction



REMEMBER
Preventive monitoring is everyone's responsibility. Stay vigilant. Stay proactive. Protect the experience.



WE WATCH
SO YOU CAN FOCUS



WE PREVENT
SO YOU CAN GROW



WE PROTECT
SO YOU CAN TRUST

EPISODE 16: DOCUMENTATION & TICKETING

Great documentation creates clarity.
Effective ticketing drives resolution.
Together, they build knowledge, improve service, and deliver excellence.

Document it right.
Ticket it right.
Do it once. Do it well.



WHY IT MATTERS

- Accurate documentation preserves institutional knowledge
- Good tickets ensure faster resolution
- Enables better reporting, trends, and RCA
- Improves team collaboration and handovers
- Supports compliance and auditing requirements

DOCUMENTATION PRINCIPLES



ACCURATE

Record facts, not assumptions.
Be correct and complete.



TIMELY

Document in real-time or as soon as possible.



CLEAR

Use simple language. Be concise and easy to understand.



CONSISTENT

Follow standard templates and naming conventions.



SECURE

Protect sensitive information.
Follow data handling policies.

TICKETING PRINCIPLES



COMPLETE

Capture all necessary details upfront.



CLASSIFY

Use the right category, impact, urgency, and priority.



COMMUNICATE

Keep customers informed with clear, timely updates.



RESOLVE

Work to closure and verify customer satisfaction.



DOCUMENT

Record actions, solutions, and lessons learned.

TICKET LIFE CYCLE



- 1. CREATE**
Capture issue with all required details.
- 2. CATEGORIZE**
Classify by type, impact, urgency, and priority.
- 3. ASSIGN**
Route to the right team or individual.
- 4. INVESTIGATE**
Analyze, gather information, and engage stakeholders.
- 5. RESOLVE**
Implement fix or workaround and test.
- 6. CLOSE**
Confirm resolution and close the ticket.
- 7. REVIEW**
Document lessons learned and improve.

TICKET INFORMATION CHECKLIST

- Short, clear summary
- Detailed description
- Affected service / system
- Impact (who is affected)
- Urgency (how quickly needed)
- Priority (P1-P4)
- Affected CI / asset
- Start time / detection time
- Symptoms / error messages
- Steps to reproduce (if known)
- Troubleshooting done
- Workarounds (if any)
- Stakeholders notified
- Attachments / logs / screenshots
- Customer contact details
- Additional notes

DOCUMENTATION STANDARDS

TYPE	PURPOSE	EXAMPLES	BEST PRACTICES
INCIDENT NOTES	Record real-time event information and actions	Incident timeline, actions taken, communications	Use timestamps, be factual, update throughout incident
KNOWLEDGE ARTICLES	Share solutions and best practices	How-to guides, troubleshooting steps, FAQs	Use templates, include screenshots, keep updated
RUNBOOKS	Provide step-by-step procedures for common tasks	On-call procedures, recovery steps, maintenance tasks	Keep simple, test regularly, review and improve
CONFIGURATION DOCS	Track system configurations and dependencies	Network diagrams, config details, IP plan, credentials	Keep current, store securely, follow naming standards
POST-INCIDENT REVIEWS	Capture root cause, actions, and improvements	RCA summary, action items, lessons learned	Be honest, focus on improvement, share with team

GOOD TICKET VS. POOR TICKET

GOOD TICKET (EXAMPLE)

Summary: Web portal login failures
Description: Multiple users unable to log in to the customer portal. Error: "Invalid credentials" after password entry.
Start Time: 2025-05-10 09:15 EST
Impact: ~150 users cannot access portal
Urgency: High | **Priority:** P2
Troubleshooting: Verified user accounts, cleared browser cache, tested on multiple browsers.
Attachments: screenshot1.png, auth.log
Contact: Jane Doe (555-123-4567)

POOR TICKET (EXAMPLE)

Summary: Login issue
Description: Users can't log in.
Start Time: (blank)
Impact: (blank)
Urgency: (blank) | **Priority:** (blank)
Troubleshooting: Didn't check anything yet.
Attachments: (none)
Contact: (blank)

TICKETING BEST PRACTICES

- Write clear, specific summaries.
- Capture all details upfront.
- Update the ticket regularly.
- Communicate status changes.
- Engage the right people early.
- Document resolution and validation.
- Close tickets only after verification.
- Use templates and standard fields.

DOCUMENTATION BEST PRACTICES

- Write for your future self and your teammates.
- Include enough detail to understand the context.
- Use consistent formatting and headings.
- Add diagrams or screenshots where helpful.
- Review and update documentation regularly.
- Store in the right location.
- Share knowledge. Reuse and improve.
- Protect sensitive data.

TOOLS WE USE

- TICKET SYSTEM**
Manage incidents, requests, problems, and changes
- WIKI / KNOWLEDGE BASE**
Central repository for articles and runbooks
- DOCUMENT REPOSITORY**
Store and version control documentation
- COLLABORATION TOOLS**
Share updates and attachments in real time
- MONITORING & LOG TOOLS**
Attach data and logs to support investigations

COMMON MISTAKES TO AVOID

- Vague or incomplete ticket details
- Wrong category or priority
- Delayed updates or no communication
- Closing tickets without validation
- Reinventing solutions not documented
- Outdated or missing documentation
- Storing docs in the wrong place
- Sharing sensitive data publicly



REMEMBER

Great documentation and effective ticketing are habits that strengthen our team and deliver exceptional service.



CAPTURE IT RIGHT
The first time is the best time.



SHARE IT WISELY
Knowledge shared is knowledge multiplied.



FOCUS ON SOLUTIONS
Document, communicate, resolve, improve.



BE PROUD
Our work today builds trust for tomorrow.

EPISODE 17: WORKING WITH FIELD ENGINEERS

We don't just monitor from the NOC.

We partner with field engineers to solve problems at the source and deliver exceptional service.

One team.

One mission.

Every site. Every time.

NOC TEAM

We see the issue and create the plan. You are our eyes and hands on site.

FIELD ENGINEER

We act on the plan and provide real-time updates from the field.

COMMUNICATE
COLLABORATE
RESOLVE

WHY IT MATTERS

- Stronger communication leads to faster resolution
- Better collaboration reduces repeat visits
- Field insights improve decision-making
- Happy customers and reliable service
- We succeed together

OUR PARTNERSHIP PRINCIPLES

RESPECT



Value each other's time, expertise, and contributions.

COMMUNICATION



Share the right information at the right time.

CLARITY



Be clear, concise, and complete in all interactions.

TRUST



Do what we say we will do. Follow through.

ACCOUNTABILITY



Own our actions and support each other to succeed.

SAFETY



Safety always comes first—on site and remotely.

CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT



Learn together and improve our processes and outcomes.

HOW WE WORK TOGETHER

1. DETECT



Issue detected in the NOC.

2. ANALYZE



Analyze the issue and determine impact and urgency.

3. ASSIGN



Create a ticket and assign to the right field engineer or team.

4. COMMUNICATE



Share clear details, expected actions, and safety info.

5. EXECUTE



Field engineer performs work and collects evidence.

6. UPDATE



Provide real-time updates, status, and any changes.

7. RESOLVE



Confirm resolution in the NOC and with the customer.

8. REVIEW



Document learnings and improve for next time.

HOW WE NEED FROM FIELD ENGINEERS

- Acknowledge tickets promptly.
- Review all ticket details and related notes.
- Ask questions if anything is unclear.
- Keep us updated throughout the job.
- Document actions taken and results.
- Upload photos, logs, and test results.
- Escalate risks, delays, or blockers early.
- Close the ticket only when fully resolved.

WHAT FIELD ENGINEERS CAN EXPECT FROM THE NOC

- Accurate and complete ticket information.
- Clear explanation of the issue and expected outcome.
- Remote support and troubleshooting assistance.
- Timely updates when plans or priorities change.
- Advocacy for the resources you need.
- Recognition of your great work.

COMMUNICATION BEST PRACTICES

- Be clear:** Use simple, direct language.
- Be complete:** Share all relevant details.
- Be timely:** Update early and often.
- Be respectful:** Assume positive intent.
- Be professional:** Keep customer focused.

TICKET INFORMATION YOU SHOULD PROVIDE

- Current status and location
- What you did and test results
- What you found (root cause if known)
- Next steps or what you need
- ETA if resolution is in progress
- Photos, screenshots, or logs

ESCALATION PATH



Field Engineer
Can't resolve or blocked



NOC Analyst
Provides support and options



NOC Lead
Escalates as needed and coordinates



Operations Manager
Business impact and final decision

TOOLS WE USE TO COLLABORATE



TICKET SYSTEM
Track work and updates



CHAT / TEAMS
Quick questions and updates



REMOTE ACCESS TOOLS
Assist and troubleshoot



KNOWLEDGE BASE
Find solutions and references



DOCUMENT REPOSITORY
Store drawings, configs, and SOPs

TIP FROM THE NOC



The more detail you provide in your updates, the faster we can help you—and the happier our customers will be.

“

Alone we can do so little;
together we can do so much.

– Helen Keller



SAFETY REMINDER

Follow all safety procedures.
Use proper PPE.
Look out for yourself and your team.
If it's not safe—stop and escalate.

REMEMBER



We are one team with a shared goal: deliver reliable service and create amazing customer experiences.

TOGETHER, WE DELIVER



We communicate openly and clearly.



We share knowledge and support.



We act with urgency and ownership.



We respect and trust each other.



We celebrate wins and learn together.

ONE TEAM. ONE MISSION.
EXCEPTIONAL SERVICE.
THAT'S THE FIRESIDE WAY.

EPISODE 18: LEADERSHIP DURING INCIDENTS

In every incident, strong leadership brings clarity, confidence, and control. We lead with calm. We communicate. We make decisions. We get results.

Lead the team.
Guide the response.
Deliver the outcome.



WHY LEADERSHIP MATTERS

- Provides focus and direction
- Reduces confusion and duplicate effort
- Improves decision-making under pressure
- Builds team confidence and morale
- Drives faster resolution and better outcomes

INCIDENT LEADERSHIP PRINCIPLES

BE CALM Stay calm and composed. Your team looks to you for stability.	TAKE OWNERSHIP Own the incident. Accept responsibility for the response and outcomes.	SET DIRECTION Define priorities, assign tasks, and keep everyone moving forward.	COMMUNICATE Share updates clearly and frequently. No surprises.	MAKE DECISIONS Make timely, informed decisions. Perfect information is not required.	EMPOWER THE TEAM Trust your team. Delegate effectively and support their decisions.	FOCUS ON OUTCOMES Keep the end goal in sight: restore service and improve the experience.
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THE INCIDENT LEADER'S PLAYBOOK

1. ASSESS Understand the scope, impact, and urgency.	2. PRIORITIZE Identify immediate priorities and desired outcomes.	3. PLAN Define the response plan and resource needs.	4. COMMUNICATE Inform the team and stakeholders. Set expectations.	5. EXECUTE Drive the plan. Monitor progress closely.	6. ADAPT Adjust as needed. Be flexible and solution-focused.	7. CLOSE Confirm resolution, document lessons, and communicate closure.
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INCIDENT LEADER CHECKLIST

- ☒ I have a clear understanding of the issue.
- ☒ I have defined our priorities.
- ☒ I have assigned roles and responsibilities.
- ☒ I am communicating regularly.
- ☒ I am removing roadblocks for the team.
- ☒ I am monitoring progress and adapting.
- ☒ I am focused on the right outcomes.
- ☒ I am supporting my team.
- ☒ I will conduct a lessons learned review.

LEADERSHIP COMMUNICATION FRAMEWORK

INFORM	Share facts, status, and decisions. Who, what, when, where, why.
ALIGN	Ensure everyone understands priorities and their role.
ENGAGE	Encourage questions, feedback, and ideas.
REASSURE	Provide confidence and acknowledge efforts.
CLOSE THE LOOP	Confirm understanding. Share outcomes and next steps.

LEADING THROUGH PRESSURE

- Focus on what you can control.
- Breathe. Pause. Think. Then act.
- Use facts, not emotions.
- Keep the big picture in mind.
- Protect your team's bandwidth and well-being.
- Celebrate small wins.

COMMON LEADERSHIP PITFALLS

- Reacting without understanding the full picture
- Over-communicating or under-communicating
- Micromanaging or not delegating
- Not updating stakeholders
- Focusing on blame instead of solutions
- Ignoring your team's well-being
- Skipping the lessons learned review

LEADERSHIP ROLES IN MAJOR INCIDENTS		
ROLE	PRIMARY RESPONSIBILITIES	SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE
INCIDENT COMMANDER	- Own the incident and set direction - Make key decisions and communicate - Ensure priorities are followed	- Clear leadership, aligned team, - timely decisions, successful resolution
OPERATIONS LEAD	- Manage technical response and resources - Coordinate work streams - Remove technical blockers	- Work is coordinated, resources are - used effectively, issues are resolved
COMMUNICATIONS LEAD	- Manage internal and external communications - Share timely updates - Maintain stakeholder trust	- Stakeholders are informed, - confident, and supportive
SUPPORT LEAD	- Support the team and manage logistics - Track actions and documentation - Ensure well-being of the team	- Team is supported, actions are - tracked, and nothing is missed

STAKEHOLDER COMMUNICATION PRIORITIES

- Be timely: Communicate early and often.
- Be transparent: Share what you know and what you don't.
- Be consistent: Use approved messages and channels.
- Be empathetic: Acknowledge the impact.
- Be solution-focused: Share what is being done.

LEADERSHIP IS SERVICE Leadership is not about having the answers. It's about guiding your team to find them, together.	TEAM CONFIDENCE When you lead well, your team performs at their best.	REMEMBER Every incident is an opportunity to lead, to learn, and to become stronger.
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“ The best leaders don't just lead in calm. They lead when it matters. That's the Fireside Way.”

EPISODE 19: THE FIRESIDE NOC STANDARD

The Fireside NOC Standard is how we operate every day. It's our commitment to excellence, consistency, and continuous improvement in everything we do.

One standard.
One team.
Exceptional every time.



WHY THE STANDARD MATTERS

- Ensures reliable service for our customers
- Creates a consistent experience across every shift and site
- Builds trust and confidence with customers and each other
- Drives performance and continuous improvement
- Defines who we are and how we deliver

THE FIRESIDE NOC STANDARD PILLARS



1. RELIABILITY

We are dependable and accountable.
We do what we say we will do.



2. COMMUNICATION

We communicate clearly, timely, and respectfully.
We share the right information, the right way.



3. OWNERSHIP

We take ownership from start to finish.
We don't pass problems—we solve them.



4. EXCELLENCE

We strive for excellence in every action.
We learn, improve, and raise the bar.



5. TEAMWORK

We support each other and win together.
We respect, trust, and celebrate our team.



6. CUSTOMER FOCUS

We focus on our customers' success. We deliver value, solutions, and exceptional service.

OUR OPERATING COMMITMENTS

- We monitor proactively and respond quickly.
- We investigate thoroughly and resolve effectively.
- We communicate often and keep everyone informed.
- We document accurately and completely.
- We follow processes and adhere to standards.
- We learn continuously and share knowledge.
- We care about our customers and each other.

THE STANDARD IN ACTION

IN EVERY...		WE...
ALERT	We acknowledge quickly, assess accurately, and act decisively.	Stay alert. Stay focused. Stay ahead.
INVESTIGATION	We gather facts, analyze deeply, and identify root cause.	Dig deep. Verify. Find the truth.
COMMUNICATION	We provide timely updates that are clear, honest, and helpful.	Over-communicate, not under-communicate.
RESOLUTION	We restore service, validate fully, and confirm with the customer.	Fix it right. Validate. Close with confidence.
HANDOFF	We share complete information and ensure continuity.	Handover clearly. Receive completely.
IMPROVEMENT	We capture lessons, apply improvements, and prevent recurrence.	Learn. Share. Improve. Make it better.

THE FIRESIDE NOC STANDARD IN PRACTICE



BE PREPARED

- ☒ Know your systems
- ☒ Understand your tools
- ☒ Follow procedures
- ☒ Keep information current



BE DISCIPLINED

- ☒ Follow the process
- ☒ Use checklists
- ☒ Document everything
- ☒ Escalate appropriately



BE COLLABORATIVE

- ☒ Share information
- ☒ Ask for help
- ☒ Offer support
- ☒ Work as one team



BE CUSTOMER-CENTRIC

- ☒ Understand their impact
- ☒ Communicate with care
- ☒ Deliver solutions
- ☒ Exceed expectations



BE IMPROVEMENT-DRIVEN

- ☒ Review and reflect
- ☒ Identify opportunities
- ☒ Implement changes
- ☒ Measure and grow

OUR STANDARD, OUR REPUTATION

Every alert we handle.
Every ticket we close.
Every customer we support.
It all adds up.

Our standard is our promise.
Our performance is our reputation.



THE FIRESIDE NOC STANDARD CHECKLIST



- ☒ I follow our processes and procedures.
- ☒ I communicate clearly and proactively.
- ☒ I take ownership and see it through.
- ☒ I focus on accurate, thorough, and timely work.
- ☒ I support my team and collaborate openly.
- ☒ I deliver solutions that create customer value.
- ☒ I learn, improve, and raise the bar every day.

OUR STANDARD. OUR COMMITMENT.

We hold ourselves to The Fireside NOC Standard because our customers, our team, and our future depend on it.

Great standards.
Great team.
Exceptional outcomes.

That's The Fireside Way.



REMEMBER



Our standard guides our decisions.



Our team lives our standard.



Our customers trust our standard.



Our results reflect our standard.



Our future depends on our commitment to the standard.

THE FIRESIDE WAY

NOC TEAM EDITION



The Fireside Way — NOC Team Edition is your practical guide to building a high-performing Network Operations Center. It captures our proven approach to teamwork, communication, processes, and leadership that deliver reliable service, faster resolution, and exceptional customer experiences.

Built from real-world experience. Driven by purpose.
Delivered by people who care.

INSIDE YOU WILL FIND:

- Proven practices for incident management, communication, and escalation.
- Guidance on teamwork, leadership, and customer-focused service.
- Standards and checklists that drive consistency and performance.
- Tools, templates, and tips you can apply every day.

OUR CORE VALUES



INTEGRITY

We do the right thing, always. We are honest, accountable, and trustworthy.



RESPECT

We value every person and perspective. We listen, support, and treat each other well.



EXCELLENCE

We strive to be our best. We improve continuously and raise the bar.



TEAMWORK

We achieve more together. We share knowledge, support one another, and win as a team.



PASSION

We care about what we do and who we serve. We bring energy and pride to our work.

ABOUT FIRESIDE GROUP

Fireside Group provides end-to-end engineering and managed services that keep networks, systems, and businesses running at their best. Our people are the heart of our success. We empower them to solve problems, deliver excellence, and make a difference for our customers every day.



500+

TEAM MEMBERS



24/7/365

ALWAYS ON
FOR OUR
CUSTOMERS



100%

COMMITMENT
TO QUALITY
& SECURITY



STRONGER
TOGETHER

ONE TEAM.
ONE MISSION.



“Alone we can do so little;
together we can do so much.”

— Helen Keller



LIVE THE FIRESIDE WAY

Protect our customers. Support each other.
Improve every day. Deliver exceptional outcomes.

ONE TEAM. ONE MISSION. EXCEPTIONAL EVERY TIME.



SCAN TO ACCESS
TOOLS, TEMPLATES
AND RESOURCES

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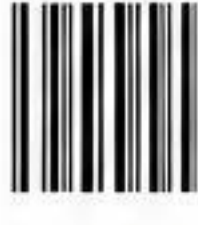


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across the globe

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